

trying to involve a five-year-old kid in sex, it would be inappropriate. If you want to see girls getting pregnant at the age of 12 to 13 years, then I have no objection. Then allow them free sex.

We will have to add honesty, truth and knowledge with *kama*. Actually, honesty is important in every aspect of life—*dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*. Economics without knowledge will create corruption, poverty and scarcity in the society. Similarly, *kama* without knowledge and honesty will result in *durachar* (wrongdoing) and *vyabhichar* (adultery), AIDS and HIV. Would you like to see a situation where a person has to get a DNA test to identify his father? That would not be a civilised society.

If there is no honesty in *kama*, there would be no idealism before the children. Population growth might become uncontrollable, or cases of foeticide would increase.

Nowadays, there is lot of stress. Married people come to me and complain, Baba, we are suffering from sexual disorders. If you want to enjoy sex, adopt yoga. Kapalbhathi is must for everybody. *Bhog* (sex) without yog would lead to diseases and weakness. Yog is a remedy for problems like sexual disorders and infertility.

The aim of spirituality is to lift our consciousness from depths to heights, from animalness to humanity to divinity. Sex only would lead towards death. If you are filled with love, pathos, kindness, energy, humility, your life will be full of constructiveness.

Sometimes people comment that Baba talks about spirituality but has a vast business empire. I tell them, you are unhappy because I am not begging before you. I don't subscribe to the view that penury is spirituality. I should live a truthful and honest life and should grow mentally and spiritually. This is our culture and tradition. And this is the way to make this world rich and developed in all respects. Sometimes people tell me with strangeness that Baba you talk about sex. I tell them, my role is like a doctor's. It is not necessary that a doctor can treat a cancer patient only if he is suffering from the disease.

Anyhow, spirituality also lifts our consciousness, and lust also leads us to worship. Sex and spirituality, both are inner consciousness of our life. If we forget other things and get obsessed with sex, then our life will be filled with brutality and sorrow. Excess of everything is always prohibited.

Now consider the case of homosexuality. Eating is done naturally by mouth. But if somebody is interested in taking food through the anus, I have no problem. But there are some literate idiots. Please pardon me for these strong words. If a person is sick and has problem in his mouth, then he is fed through the nose with the help of a tube. But a healthy person will always eat through the mouth. I hope, I have made myself clear.

Now, we talk about free sex. There is nothing free in this world. Whether it is the sun or the earth, everything is bound by some rule, some controls. So there is nothing like free sex. Everybody has to follow some regulation, observe some dignity, whether it is the media, the baba or the babu.

"I feel, next to God, sex is the most misunderstood subject"

SWAMI SATYA VEDANT AUTHOR & PHILOSOPHER



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Sex and spirituality appear to be different but essentially they are interconnected. Perceptions may of course differ but they are not in conflict with each other, rather they are part of a continuum. Spirituality in a sense means to achieve a certain state of freedom, liberation. Sex, if it can be incorporated, if it can be applied along with meditation and awareness can also bring us to the state of liberation. The necessary thing for us to understand and explore briefly is the mystery of sex and spirituality. God has given this life energy, this creative energy not only to humans but to animals as well. So it is a given thing, it is not that you and I have created. The only problem is that we apply double standards in accepting this reality. In fact, we are so hypocritical, often schizophrenic in recognising the power, the existence, and the reality, as is known as sex energy.

I feel, next to God, sex is the most misunderstood subject. The reason is, sages have seen sex in terms of spirituality and a sublime form of energy, and they have seen this orgasmic union, enlightenment of dissolving male female yin-yang polarity. Only when one has understood, experienced and seen the limitation as well as futility of the sexual pleasure, can one take first steps in spirituality, and his insight is to be natural. The East has always favoured the ultimate experience and they have called it ecstatic ecstasy. And I would like to invent a word here to make this a little clearer. We may like to call it sextasy. Sextasy would mean a sexual union of the orgasmic state one arrives where there is no thought, no idea, no mind, one goes beyond it all. So we can see a fourfold evolution of sextasy—one is sex which is union